

- **Eraser Tool-** The Eraser Tool in Photoshop permanently erases pixels on a layer. It can also be used to paint in a previous history state.
- **Background Eraser Tool-** Erases areas of similar colour in an image by painting over them.
- **Gradient Tool-** Draws gradual blends between multiple colours. The Gradient Editor lets you create and customize your own gradients.
- **Paint Bucket Tool-** Fills an area of similar colour with your Foreground colour or a pattern. The “Tolerance” value determines the range of colours that will be affected around the area where you clicked.
- **Blur Tool-** As the name suggests, blurs and softens areas you paint over with the tool.
- **Sharpen Tool-** Again as the name suggests, sharpens the areas you paint over.
- **Smudge Tool-** Smudges and smears the areas you paint over. It can also be used to create a finger painting effect.
- **Pen Tool-** Draw extremely precise paths, vector shapes or selections.
- **Freeform Pen Tool-** Similar to pen tool but you can draw freehand paths or shapes. Anchor points are automatically added to the path as you draw.
- **Convert Point Tool-** On a path, click on a smooth anchor point with the Convert Point Tool to convert it to a corner point. Click a corner point to convert it to a smooth point.
- **Rectangle Tool-** Draws rectangular vector shapes, paths or pixel shapes.
- **The next few tools-** rounded rectangle, ellipse, polygon and line- are similar to the rectangle tool and self explanatory in nature.
- **Custom Shape Tool-** Select and draw custom shapes. Choose from Photoshop’s built-in custom shapes or create your own.
- **Hand Tool-** The Hand Tool lets us click and drag an image around on the screen to view different areas when zoomed in.

Layers

The most aspect of any photo editing tool. For editing or creating composite images, Layers are the most important feature. Think of layers like sheets of paper, one on top of each other. Every sheet has a particular image or attributes to it. These sheets can be made transparent so that they form part of the composite, edited independently, rearranged, removed or added.

You can use layers to add several attributes like adding text to an image, adding vector graphic shapes, applying a special effect such as a drop shadow